tour of India to get to know people, to connect with them and to bring them into the Congress fold. In 1921, he was given control of the party. To see the 1942 Quit India/Bharat Chhodo movement in its historical context, it is important to study the trajectory of the Congress from 1920 to 1942 through 1931.

That context has a close resemblance to the context in which the Bharat Jodo movement has sprung up. In 2002, the Congress looked far away from being able to counter the 'India Shining' rhetoric of the NDA government. A decade later, in 2012, a Congress-led UPA government managed to usher in landmark pieces of legislation on the Right to Education and the Right to Information, besides creating an excellent livelihood support programme through the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, better known as MGNREGA. But again, over the past ten years, India has undergone a complete transformation. We have a government that cosies up to a few super-rich business families and has systematically emasculated all counterbalancing democratic institutions meant to restrain a runaway executive.[3] Mainstream media has been turned into a government lapdog[4] and the constitutionally guaranteed freedom of expression exists as if only to remind us of its real-life absence. Central investigative agencies such as the Enforcement Directorate have been weaponized with laws that give them unbridled powers to search, seize, arrest and spread fear. The sharp rise in hate speech and hate crimes directed against minorities since 2014 has no parallel in India's history since 1947.

Outside India, war clouds are thickening and the community of nations seems ill-equipped to effectively check aggressive intent and wars. The rise of the Taliban in Afghanistan, the popular uprising in Sri Lanka, the tensions in Ukraine and Gaza, the escalation of tension between India and its neighbours, and the sharp rise in unemployment and poverty are all factors that bring back memories of Hitler's rise to power. The BJP's unceasing propaganda war[5] and its ritual invocation of a fake militant nationalism also remind us of those times. The divisions in the Opposition camp and the factionalism within Opposition parties also make 2022 uncannily similar to conditions in 1942.